NON-CURRICULAR OFF-CAMPUS ACTIVITIES GUIDELINES

(2017 Revised Edition)

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NON-CURRICULAR OFF-CAMPUS ACTIVITIES GUIDELINES

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I. Introduction

Xavier University recognizes the role of off-campus activities in student's holistic formation. Thus, students are allowed to conduct activities outside the University to enable them achieve their goals and serve valuable purpose. However, it is important to note that an off-campus activity entails risks. With safety precautions, students can reduce these risks and meet their objectives.

The following guidelines are articulation of CHED Memorandum Order Number 63 and meant to provide students clear perspective in organizing/conducting off-campus activities. Curricular-based off-campus activities (e.g. On-the-Job Training, Educational Tours, Field Study, Research Sampling and Attendance in degree program) are not covered by these guidelines. Curricular-based off-campus activities are subject to the approval of the Academic Vice President.

II. Definition of Terms

For the purpose of these guidelines, the following terms are defined as follows:

1. Curricular Activities – activities required in class/course and form integral part of an instructional program; without participating in these activities, the student may not earn mark for the subject/program

2. Non-Curricular Activities – refer to activities that are not related to any subject or instructional program

3. Off-Campus Activities – refer to all activities that are done outside any of the XU campuses

4. XU Campuses – include the following: Corrales Ave, Macasandig, Manresa, CIT Manresa, Pueblo, Xavier Ateneo Sports Centre

5. Within the City – bound by the following: Opol (westbound) and Tagoloan (eastbound)

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III. General Provisions

A. Scope

These guidelines cover all non-curricular off-campus activities of the following student organizations/groups:

1. Central Student Government
2. College Councils
3. Co-Curricular Organizations
4. Extra-Curricular Organizations (including performing arts companies)
5. Program-Based Groups
6. Religious Organizations
7. Varsities (under University Athletics Office)
8. Social Development Cluster
9. Professional Student Organizations (Medicine, Law, Graduate School)

Activities covered include but are not limited to the following:

1. Team/Community-Building Activities
2. Seminars, conferences, symposia, trainings
3. Competitions
4. Volunteer work including peer helper programs, relief operations, community outreach and immersion
5. Sports Activities
6. Advocacy projects and campaigns
7. Inter-school competitions/tournaments
8. Mission-based activities (e.g., retreat, recollection, etc.)
9. Culture and arts performances and competitions

B. Nature of Off-Campus Activities, Risk Level Matrix and Requirements

When students engage in off-campus activities, certain set of requirements must be accomplished prior to the activity. Previously, all off-campus activities require parents' consent forms and an accomplished off-campus activity form. Recent improvements made in the guidelines include risk level assessment which determines whether or not the activity requires parents' consent forms and other requirements. Please see the following details.

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Nature	Venue	Risk Level	Parents' Consent Form (Form A12.1)	Minimum Other Requirements
• General Assembly • Meeting • Evaluation Meetings • Acquaintance Party (or the like) • Graduation Balls • Seminars/ Conferences (Indoor Sessions; should be until 10:00 PM only)	Hotels/Restaurants/ Function Rooms/ Retreat/Seminar Venues (and the like), Malls within the City	Low	Not Required	
	Outside the city	High	Required	• Off-Campus Activity Form (Form A12) • First Aid Kit • LTFRB Registration • Driver's License • Permit for Out-of-Line Vehicle (if applicable)
• Sports • Community/Team Building • Spiritual Formation Session • BOLTS/ Workshops/ Trainings/Leadership Camp (with Physical Team Activities)	All venues outside any of the XU campuses (excluding Jasaan)	High	Required	• Off-Campus Activity Form (Form A12) • First Aid Kit • LTFRB Registration • Driver's License • Permit for Out-of-Line Vehicle (if applicable) • Medical Certificate (for sports or related activities)
• All Overnight or Stay-in Activities	All venues (within and outside any of the XU campuses)	High	Required	
• All other forms of off-campus activities	Beach Resort/Resort, Natural Park, Natural Bodies of Water, Adventure Park, Unofficial Business venues within or outside the city (e.g. family farms)	High	Required	

Others:

1. **Community-based projects or activities** (e.g. social outreach, immersion, mountain climbing) - should have advance and proper coordination with community leaders or local government units; Acknowledged letter from the concerned office/agency or a MOA should be secured and submitted to SACDEV before the activity

2. **Regional/National activities** – must have proper coordination with the LGU where the venue belongs; the mayor or a representative may be invited to the activity

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3. **Field assessment/sampling** (for specific data/specimen) – must have permit for collecting from the concerned government agency (e.g. DENR); please consult OSA-SACDEV for reference

4. **Pre-implementation activities** (e.g. ocular inspection to a venue outside the city) – requires parents' consent form but project proposal is not necessary

5. **Participation/ official representation of the University in regional, national or international gatherings/ competitions** - requires approval of the DSA; Students must send a letter to SACDEV with attached acceptance letter from the organizers

6. **Educational Tours, Field Trips and the like.** Student organizations are no longer qualified to organize educational tours, field trips and similar activities. These activities have to be organized by the academic units and approved by the Academic Vice President

IV. Specific Guidelines

A. Venues

1. Allowed Venues

a. As much as possible, venues of off-campus activities should be near the campus in order to minimize cost. The venue should be relevant to the nature, purpose or objectives of the activity.
b. In the case of social outreach and immersion activities, students should formally communicate to the community/center and secure formal entry permit from the barangay or community leader.
c. Areas or places declared under threat, with on-going natural calamity or under the state of calamity/emergency are automatically restricted destination for any student activity.
d. Areas or places that involve security, safety and health hazards such as killings, robbery, shootings or virus outbreak are also restricted venues for any type of activity.
e. In the event where the venue of an already approved activity is suddenly placed under any of the above conditions, the University reserves its discretion to withdraw the approval of the activity.

2. Safe Venue Assessment Matrix

Below is a matrix that helps students evaluate the safety of their prospect venue. The matrix involves a scoring system with 50 as total points.

Students must refer to the criteria indicated on the first column and must objectively rate their prospect venue according to the points assigned per criterion. The points that should be given for each criterion are either the points assigned to it or "zero". It's *black or white*, *yes or no*. There are no in-between points, except "g". If the venue meets the given criteria, students should give the assigned points; otherwise zero point should be given.

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For a prospect venue to be considered safe, it should reach the passing score of 25. Otherwise, students should consider another venue.

At any rate, when a given criterion does not apply to the venue being assessed, the points assigned to it should be deducted from the total points of 50. The passing score is also adjusted accordingly (should be at least half of the total points).

Criteria *(Yes or No?)*	**Assigned Points** *(or zero)*
a. Is the venue a registered business entity?	4
b. Is the outdoor venue enclosed by a fence? *(for beaches, room accommodation is at least enclosed by a fence)*	4
c. Does the venue have designated security officers?	5
d. Does the venue have fully functional CCTV cameras?	3
e. Is there a stand-by life guard or rescue group? *(if applicable)*	5
f. Does the venue have fire safety facilities e.g. fire extinguisher, fire exit, sprinkler? *(if applicable)*	5
g. Is the venue near a hospital? *Points vary according to:* (proximity within 10 km = 2 pts; 8km = 3 pts; 5km = 4pts)	4
h. Is the venue near a police station? (within 5 km proximity)	2
i. Is there a stand-by emergency vehicle and driver in the venue? *Note: This could also be a vehicle owned by a participant of the activity.*	4
j. Is the venue accessible through a regular public transport?	4
k. Is it far from a war conflict/virus outbreak/calamity area *(at least 100 km away or approximately 2 hours travel time from the venue)*	5
l. Is there cellular phone signal/ mobile data coverage in the area?	5
Total	**50**

B. Transportation

1. Land Trip

Students must not compromise their own safety in choosing vehicles for their activity. Vehicles used for the activity must be carefully assessed. Proper orientation to drivers must be provided.

The following are required for submission to SACDEV along with the Off-Campus Activity Form and Parents' Consent Form (Forms A12 and A12.1) for chartered vehicles:

a. LTFRB Franchise Certification
b. Driver's License
c. Special LTFRB Permit for destinations that are "out-of-line"
d. Travel and Tour Operator Accreditation Certificate by DOT in case a travel agency is tapped for the activity

This means that hiring of random jeepneys/vehicles on the day of the activity is no longer allowed.

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Moreover, certain conditions must be met in order to further ensure the safety of students:

a. The driver of the vehicle should be instructed to follow the safer route and observe allowable speed limit. Speed limit varies per city.
b. Strictly, no student is allowed to go to the venue riding a bike/motorcycle.
c. If the student prefers to ride his/her own vehicle (except, motorcycle or bike), specific permission from his/her parents should be indicated in the student travel form (Form A12.1). This rule is also applied to those who want to ride in a fellow participant's vehicle. The vehicle should be in convoy with the main vehicle.
d. Students should strictly observe the seating capacity of the vehicle. No overloading allowed.
e. Students must be properly seated inside the vehicle. No student is accommodated in the aisle, on the roof or on the boarding platform. Seatbelts must be securely fastened *(when applicable).*
f. Huge/heavy equipment or cargo should be transported in a separate vehicle.

2. Sea/Air Travel

The University rests its confidence in existing laws and regulations governing the safety of passengers during sea or air travel. Students are advised to strictly abide by the rules imposed on seaports and airports.

a. Purchase tickets in authorized or legitimate ticketing outlets.
b. Do not bring restricted items at the port.
c. Sign the ferry/vessel passenger's manifesto.
d. In case of motorized boat, life vests must be worn throughout the trip.
e. Follow the crew's safety instructions.

C. Itinerary

1. Destination and Schedule

Students must strictly follow the approved itinerary as stated in the project proposal. Only places that have been approved must be visited. Side trips are not allowed.

Adjustments with time may be allowed upon the discretion of the organization within justifiable circumstances, as long as it does not completely deviates from the approved schedule (e.g. slight delay in the departure time, weather disturbances and the like). In doing so, the organization must be able to assess that they are not exposing students to risks. More so, the organization must properly communicate such to SACDEV (e.g. phone call).

2. Deviations

Ideally, all students participating in the activity should depart from and return to point of origin together. A student who arranges for adjustments in his/her itinerary may be allowed provided that proper notation is written by the parents in the Student's Travel Agreement Form (Form A12.1) and submitted to SACDEV.

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a. Catching-up to the venue is only allowed within the city only (up to Tagoloan for east bound or Opol for westbound). Farther than these bounds, catching up is no longer allowed. Only students who are listed in the Off-Campus Activity Form (Form A12) are allowed to catch-up provided that his/her parent indicated this on his/her travel form (Form A12.1). The student may commute or use own vehicle (except motorcycle or bicycle).
b. Going home ahead of the group is allowed as long as this is indicated by the parent in the student's travel form (Form A12.1).
c. During an out of town trip where the student prefers to stay behind after the activity to visit relatives/ visit other places, s/he may be allowed provided that this is indicated by the parent in the student's travel form (A12.1). In this case, the University waives its responsibility upon release of the student. For in-town off-campus activities, staying behind is strictly not allowed.
d. In case where the student has a relative who fetches him/her within the duration of the activity, the accompanying moderator/faculty must require the parent to call him/her for verification. The parent shall also be required to send an email to the moderator for documentation purposes.

D. Conduct of the Activity

When the required documents have been submitted and approval has been granted, the students and the moderator or his/her duly designated representative assume full responsibility for their actions during the activity and the consequences that may arise from them.

The following should be strictly observed during the activity:

1. Students should bring their University ID for identification purposes.
2. Students' attendance must be checked throughout the activity.
3. A person in-charge of first-aid must be designated. The organization must bring first-aid kit which may be asked from the University Health Services Office.
4. Male and female students must be housed in separate rooms.
5. Non-participants of the activity are not allowed to stay inside the rooms.
6. Students must strictly observe curfew enforced by the accompanying moderator/faculty. Monitoring should be done at a regular interval to make sure that students stay inside their rooms once the curfew is in effect.
7. Strictly, smoking and drinking alcoholic beverages are not allowed.
8. Strictly, no gambling allowed.
9. Students must behave befitting Atenean gentlemen and ladies in the conduct of the off-campus activity *(Please refer to the Code of Conduct in the Student Handbook for the detailed presentation of expected behavior from students).*

E. Accompanying Moderator/Faculty

1. **Specific Considerations.** The following serves as guide for Moderators in the process of organizing and implementing students' off-campus activity:

   a. All off-campus activities require attendance and supervision of a moderator/faculty, except the following:

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1) Participation/ official representation of students in a leadership conference/ congress/ summit that do not include provision for Moderator (e.g. AYLC, Buklod Atenista)
2) Participation in debate tournaments (maximum of 3 students only)

b. Moderators must be present the entire duration of the off-campus activity.
c. If the moderator is not available for the activity, s/he should designate his/her representative, subject to the approval of the DSA.
d. The designated representative must be full-time employee of the University and must have appropriate knowledge on University Non-Curricula Off-campus Activities Guidelines.
e. The number of moderators/ accompanying faculty required for off-campus activities is based on the ratio: 1 moderator/faculty for every 40 students (1:40).
f. In case of more than 40 students, the moderator must invite other University personnel to join him/her in accompanying the students. Identify the over-all leader among the accompanying faculty/staff. This must be clearly communicated to SACDEV.

2. **Duties and Responsibilities.** The following are the duties and responsibilities of the accompanying moderator/faculty during the activity:

a. Serves as designated official of the University and enforces the guidelines for student travel as stated herein and summarized in the Student Travel Agreement (Form A12.1)
b. Serves as contact person in case of emergency and designates student officer(s) to assist him/her. Emergency contact number(s) assigned by the organization must be disseminated to the students
c. Ensures that the established and approved travel itinerary is strictly followed
d. Ensures that students stay with the group and participate in all sessions of the activity
e. Enforces curfew time and sees to it that students are in their designated rooms while the curfew is in effect. Monitoring shall be done at a regular interval to ensure students' cooperation.
f. Implements other rules or system which he/she may create in relation to managing the students
g. Report to SACDEV any emergency which may arise through the mobile number(s) provided

In case of attending seminars/conventions, the accompanying moderator/faculty serves as delegation head and facilitates necessary coordination between the organizers and the students.

F. Fees

Students may be required to pay reasonable amount to defray cost of transportation, entrance fees and related expenses, subject to consultation with the students by the officers and approval of SACDEV. Exact amount of counterpart should be stated in the project proposal and letter to parents.

Student organizations should cover expenses of accompanying moderators/faculty.

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V. Processing an Off-Campus Activity Application

The process and requirements for off-campus activities could somehow appear lengthy and thus require time. But the key to successful off-campus activities is planning for them ahead of time. Start preparing at least 1 month before the activity and anticipate possible requirements which may be asked.

A. Specific Considerations

The following could serve as guide at the early stage of your planning:

1. Define what the project is, its scope, purpose, deliverables, etc.
2. Identify possible expenses which may be incurred (e.g. transportation cost, food and accommodation expenses).
3. Create a draft of the schedule and itinerary.
4. Do an informal survey (or canvassing) of expected expenses.
5. If you are anticipating a community partner, have advance communication with them for things which may be necessary (e.g. necessary coordination, things to bring, permits, transportation arrangements, etc.). However, do not finalize agreement with them yet.
6. For convenience in arranging for transportation, have a list of trusted operators/drivers where you can ask for readily-available requirements (e.g. LTFRB Franchise, license, etc.)
7. For long distance, stay-in activities, secure contact details and directions of nearest police station and hospital.
8. When necessary, have prior coordination with the LGU for your visit at the venue.

B. Procedure

Students will not be allowed to participate in "high-risk" off-campus activities without written consents from their parents. This is facilitated through the Student Travel Agreement Form (Form A12.1).

Students should follow the following steps:

Step 1:
Prepare draft of parents' consent letter; should detail the name of the activity, date, time, venue, purpose, required fees *(if any)* and designated contact person and number of the organization; should be prepared by the Project Head, noted by the President and Moderator and endorsed by the DSA.

Step 2:
Input pertinent details in the Student Travel Agreement/Parents' Consent Form (Form A12.1).

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Step 3:
Attach draft of parents' consent letter and a sample of Form A12.1 to the project proposal of the off-campus activity and submit to SACDEV at least 2 weeks before the activity to have enough time for processing the parents' consents and other requirements.

Be sure to detail the travel itinerary in the project proposal and schedule of orientation to your participants.

Step 4:
After SACDEV approval, replicate and disseminate parents' consent letters to participants together with Form A12.1 (1 set per participant). *Set ideal deadline for participants to submit Form A12.1 back to the organization to meet the deadline set by SACDEV.*

Step 5:
Collect and compile accomplished Forms A12.1 from participants.
Parents should keep the letter with them for reference purposes (e.g. contact details).

Special cases:

1. For married undergraduate students, Form A12.1 should be signed by their spouse.
2. For students without parents in town, Form A12.1 may be signed by their declared legal guardian in their school records.
3. For students without legal guardians in town, Form A12.1 must bear e-signatures of their parents. Moderators must be able to check authenticity of the signatures by calling the parents of the students. Strictly no signature from landlady (for dormers) allowed.

Step 6:
Accomplish the Off-campus Activity Form (Form A12) by listing the names of confirmed participants with corresponding contact info. Attach accomplished Student Travel Agreement Form (Form A12.1) to it.

Prepare 2 sets:
Set 1 – Form A12 (with original signatures) and attach accomplished copies of Forms A12.1.
Set 2 - Copy of Form A12 only

Step 7:
Submit both sets (Forms A12 and A12.1) to SACDEV at least 3 days before the activity for review and approval.

Special Requirements:

1. Photocopy of any of the following applicable documents from your vehicle operator - LTFRB Registration, Driver's License, Permit for Out of Line vehicle or DOT Accreditation Certificate

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2. For social outreach/immersion, copy of entry permit or acknowledged letter of entry from the concerned community leaders/LGU/NGO
3. For field assessment/sampling, copy of permit for collecting data/specimen from the concerned community leaders/LGU
4. For sports or related activities, medical certificates of participants

Step 8:
Once approved, claim your copy of the request (Set 2, Form A12).
The organization should bring this to the venue for reference purposes (e.g. contact numbers) in case of emergency.

Note: Approval of Off-Campus activities of graduate level students shall follow the same process, except they are not required to submit Student Travel Agreement/Parent's Consent Form (Form A12.1). Only Steps 6 to 8 are applied.

Step 9:
Conduct pre-departure orientation to your participants before the activity day. The following should be explained: assembly area and time, transportation arrangements, detailed schedule and itinerary, venue/accommodation, food arrangements, things to bring, restricted items, travel rules (as stated in Form A12.1).

Step 10:
Proceed to your off-campus activity.

VI. Safety and Security Tips

The following are given as advice to student organizations to further improve safety and security measures:

1. Do not bring valuables as much as possible.
2. Do not allow non-participants to get inside your room.
3. Identify food restrictions of the participants.
4. Contact details of the activity organizers may be printed at the back of the participant's nametags for easier access (if any).
5. Before the group departs from a certain place, headcounts should be done.
6. Keep contact details of the staff/security of the venue, nearest hospital and nearest police station. Some may be searched on-line.
7. Look for a floor plan of the building where your group is staying and identify the nearest emergency exits.
8. If your organization is exclusively contracting the whole park/resort/residence, a map of the entire place should be studied to identify emergency exit and establish evacuation plan.

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VII. Post Activity Requirements

A. Debriefing/ Processing Session *(as it applies)*

To facilitate more meaningful learning experience for social outreach activities, immersions and field training, student organizations are encouraged to conduct debriefing/processing session after the activity.

B. Evaluation Report

Evaluation should be conducted to analyze/assess the output and learning outcomes and measure the success of the activity. This should be included in the documentation report required after the activity.

Insights gained from the evaluation must be used as basis for planning the next activity (e.g. timely accomplishment of requirements, itinerary, schedule, venue, food, etc.).

C. Documentation Report

As a standard practice, students are required to accomplish and submit documentation report after the activity. Attendance sheets must be attached to it.

D. Liquidation Report

Liquidation Report should be submitted within 15 days after the activity. Original official receipts should be attached. In case where the transport provider does not have official receipts, the organizers should use the payment voucher provided by SACDEV. The name of the operator, plate number, number of passengers and destination should be clearly indicated in the payment voucher. When it involves air travel, a boarding pass should be attached.

Please see full guidelines for liquidation and audit guidelines available at SACDEV for more details.

III. Non-Compliance of these Guidelines

Should any violation of the above guidelines is committed, SACDEV and when necessary, the Review and Recognition Committee (RRC) will assess the extent thereof to determine the level of responsibility and the type of sanction to be imposed (e.g. individual students or whole organization). In the event where the whole organization is found responsible, the whole organization will be disqualified to conduct off-campus activities for a period which will be determined by RRC. For individual students responsible for an offense, they shall receive sanction individually. The provisions stated in the Code of Conduct in the Student Handbook shall be applied.

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